

uTorrent popularity dropping

The latest version of uTorrent has been facing some criticism over unfairness in their new protocol called uTP

Youtube captioning

Youtube uses voice recognition to enable auto captioning feature for all English videos



From left to right, Gautam Anand (Google), Lalit Modi (IPL) and Shailesh Rao (Google) announcing live streaming of IPL matches on YouTube

Airtel provides 2Mbps connections for cricket

India loves its cricket, and Airtel understands this. From March 12th to the 25th, Airtel Broadband customers enjoyed speeds of 2 Mbps no matter their plan while streaming content from YouTube's IPL channel, www.youtube.com/ipl. These speeds were provided by Airtel on a best effort basis. Users were able to stream with their Airtel Broadband connections. Tariff plans stayed the same however, and data transfer limits too.

Around the same time, Airtel also upgraded some of new broadband plans. Most plans have the speeds doubled. The new 4 Mbps plans are now available for between Rs. 899 and Rs. 1,799 but with download limits between 6 GB and 50 GB. The plans are named "Impatience".

Nintendo 3DS – Glassless 3D experience

Nintendo has announced a 3D successor to the Nintendo DS line of handheld gaming

devices, tentatively called the Nintendo 3DS. According to claims by Nintendo, the video game console will feature "3D

effects" that can be enjoyed "without the need for any special glasses".

Since technology for such a feat is not yet available, it can be safely assumed that Nintendo is sitting on a golden egg, one that will keep other portable gaming consoles lagging even further behind. Further information about the new Nintendo 3DS will be revealed by the company at the E3 event this year, which starts June 15th in Los Angeles. The new Nintendo 3DS will also be backward compatible with the Nintendo DS and DSi.

Steam coming to OS X

Steam is a game distribution service by Valve that is some-

thing of a hybrid between a cloud based service and a desktop client. Games can be purchased, downloaded and then updated using the Steam client. Steam was primarily available for Windows so far but now, Valve is working on Mac OS X version.

This was close on the heels of the March 5 announcement by Valve on the upcoming release of Portal 2. Valve's popular games such as Half-Life 2 and Team Fortress 2 are likely to be the ones available for Mac OS X in April. With the various platforms available, this may be a case of too little too late for Mac users who are interested in gaming. We say – better late than never! 

We talked to Sanat Rao, Director of Developing Markets, Intel Corp.

In many ways bringing processor "intelligence" to everyday objects seems obvious. What were the challenges getting to this point? And what are the challenges moving forward?

The Internet is bringing transformative changes to the embedded world. The era of intelligent connectivity for everyday objects has started and will pick up pace rapidly. According to a recent IDC study, there will be 15-billion devices connected to the Internet by 2015, most of which will be embedded devices. These products require chips with high-performance; at the same time, the devices require a small form-factor and low thermals, thereby implying a higher level of integration. With our embedded Atom family of processors, we are now able to achieve all of the above.

With processors come complexity, and that brings device failure or breakdown into the picture. Would we need to reboot our fridge and install more RAM along with defrosting it? How do you design everyday "intelligent" equipment we rely on, to not fail?

This is an excellent question. It all boils down to software; today, a refrigerator or a washing machine doesn't really require an operating system, because it is a single function device



with specific hard-coded functions. The moment you connect these devices to the Internet, there are a host of new functions these devices can perform. The key is to make sure that the device has a robust OS. In addition, hardware assisted manageability features are a major factor in keeping these device up and running. For example, Intel's vPro technology allows a device to be remotely managed from an external location, independent of the state of the OS. So a refrigerator manufacturer could conceivably run a remote-management center to support all the "connected" devices that have been deployed. 

Read the full interview online at thinkdigit.com/d/intel_interview